

Calm & Oak

THE PREMIUM PLAN

The Japandi *Home Plan*

*Room by room — your palette, your two woods,
the shopping order, the budget, the checklist.*



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A whole home, one room *at a time*.

The free cheat-sheet tells you which palette. This plan tells you what to do with it — the order to buy in, what each room costs, and the exact checklist to work from.

Work one room at a time, in the order on the next page. Finish a room before you start the next — a half-done house never reads calm. Each room follows the same four steps: **set the palette**, **fix the two woods**, **buy in the right order**, and **tick the checklist**. The budgets are starting-point ranges in USD; adjust to your own market.

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Four steps, every *room*.

i

Set the palette

Pick one palette per room from the five (next page) and commit to it before you buy anything. The base — the largest surface — sets the room's temperature; warm neutral, never a cool blue-white. One room, one palette.

ii

Fix the two woods

One light wood (oak, ash) and at most one dark (walnut). The wood you already own usually decides this for you — match the new pieces to it rather than fighting it. Two woods read as a relationship; a third reads as clutter.

iii

Buy in the right order

Big and structural first (the anchor furniture), soft and textural next (linen, wool, rugs), small and decorative last (ceramics, one print, one plant). Buying the small things first is the most common way a room stalls half-finished.

iv

Tick the checklist

Each room has a numbered checklist — the pieces that, together, make the room read as Japandi rather than just tidy. Don't add beyond it. The discipline of stopping is the whole aesthetic.

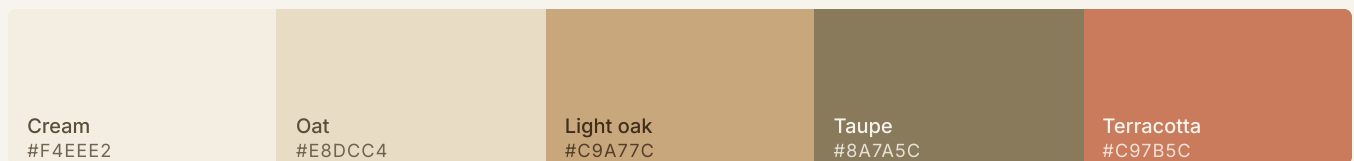
The one rule above the four

Finish a room before starting the next. A whole house in progress reads as chaos; one finished calm room reads as intention — and teaches you the moves for the rest.

Your palette, your two *woods*.

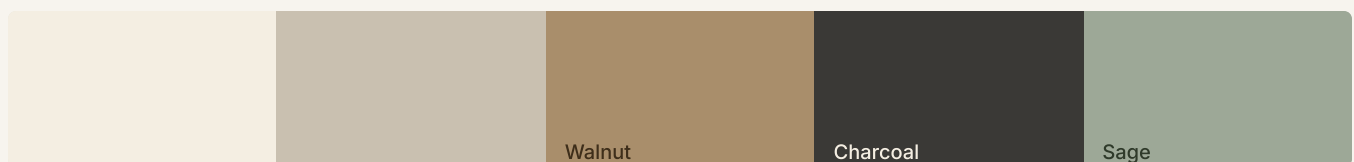
The five signature palettes, condensed. Pick one per room (the matcher is in the free cheat-sheet).
The wood row below each is the pairing that sits calmly on it.

01 · Oat & oak — the warm default



Woods: light oak as the lead, a touch of walnut for depth. **Best for:** bedrooms, living rooms, north-facing rooms.

02 · Charcoal & cream · 03 · Stone & sage



Woods: walnut-led, cream and stone around it. **Best for:** offices & dining (charcoal), bedrooms & bathrooms (sage).

04 · Terracotta accent · 05 · Warm grey monochrome



Woods: light oak / ash, the wood carrying all the warmth. **Best for:** kitchens & entryways (terracotta), layered living rooms & offices (monochrome).

STEP THREE

Buy in *this* order.

Every room is built in three waves. Finish each wave before the next — it stops you spending the small budget on cushions while the room still has no anchor.

1

The anchor (50–65% of the budget)

One large structural piece in your lead wood — the sofa, the bed frame, the desk, the dining table. Buy this first and buy it well; everything else relates to it. If you only spend on one thing this season, spend here.

2

The soft layer (25–35%)

Linen, wool, and the rug — the texture that makes a Japandi room warm rather than bare. Three weights of the same neutral beats one of five colours. The rug grounds the room; size it so the front legs of the anchor sit on it.

3

The quiet detail (10–15%)

Last, and least: one or two ceramics, one print, one plant, the single accent note. This is where the room comes alive — and where most rooms overshoot. Buy the checklist, then stop.

A note on "buy it well"

Japandi rewards fewer, better things. One honest oak table outlasts three trend pieces and costs less over a decade. When the budget is tight, buy the anchor and live with bare-but-good until you can add the soft layer — never the reverse.

04 The living room

PALETTE

01 *Oat & oak*

WOODS

Light oak + walnut

BUDGET RANGE

\$1,400–3,200

The anchor is the sofa — cream or oat linen, low and unfussy, legs in light oak. Float it on a wool or jute rug large enough that the front legs sit on it; an undersized rug is the single most common living-room mistake. Layer two cushion weights and one throw in the same palette, a low oak coffee table, and stop. One print, one stoneware vessel, one plant. The room should read as **three materials repeated** — wood, linen, stoneware — not as a collection.

- ☐ Linen sofa, cream or oat, oak legs — the anchor
- ☐ Wool or jute rug, sized to the seating — front legs on the rug
- ☐ Low oak coffee table — one, not a nest
- ☐ Two cushions + one throw — same palette, two weights
- ☐ One floor or table lamp, warm bulb — 2700K, never cool white
- ☐ One framed print + one stoneware vessel — the only decorative pieces
- ☐ One plant — olive, rubber, or a single stem

05 The bedroom

PALETTE

01 *Oat & oak* / 03 *Stone & sage*

WOODS

Oak or walnut

BUDGET RANGE

\$1,100–2,600

The bedroom wants the warmest, quietest palette — oat & oak, or stone & sage if you want it cooler and more *shibui*. The anchor is a low bed frame in oak or walnut; keep it close to the floor. Dress it in three tones of one neutral — fitted sheet, duvet, one folded throw at the foot — never five subtly different creams. Two matching nightstands, two warm lamps, blackout linen curtains that puddle slightly. **Avoid charcoal here** — it absorbs more light than it gives back and reads gloomy in a room you wake up in.

- ☐ Low oak or walnut bed frame — the anchor, kept low
- ☐ Linen bedding in three tones of one neutral — sheet, duvet, throw
- ☐ Two matching nightstands — symmetry calms a bedroom
- ☐ Two warm table lamps — 2700K, dimmable if possible
- ☐ Linen curtains, floor-length — slight puddle, not pooling
- ☐ One wool rug underfoot — warmth on waking
- ☐ One print above the bed + one ceramic — the only accents

06 The home office

PALETTE

02 *Charcoal & cream*

WOODS

Walnut + oak

BUDGET RANGE

\$900–2,200

The office is where Japandi earns its "warm minimalism" — minimal is not empty. The anchor is a solid-wood desk (oak or ash); one darker walnut element — a tray, a shelf, a pen cup — gives it depth. Keep the desktop to a **six-object maximum**: laptop, lamp, one ceramic vessel, a notebook, one plant, one tray to corral the rest. Cable management is part of the aesthetic, not separate from it. One charcoal element in the room — a lampshade, a framed sumi-e print — against cream walls; in low light, swap charcoal for a softer warm-black.

- ☐ Solid oak or ash desk — the anchor
- ☐ One supportive chair, wood or muted upholstery — comfort over sculpture
- ☐ Warm task lamp — 2700–3000K, adjustable
- ☐ One walnut tray or shelf — the second wood
- ☐ Cable management — hidden is the point
- ☐ One charcoal accent — shade or framed print — just one
- ☐ One plant + one ceramic vessel — the six-object limit

07 The kitchen & dining

PALETTE

04 *Terracotta accent*

WOODS

Light oak

BUDGET RANGE

\$700–2,000

Kitchens are mostly hard surfaces, so warmth has to be added deliberately. The terracotta-accent palette does it with one warm note against warm cream and light oak, grounded by a single soft-black element — a lamp base, a faucet, a framed print. The dining anchor is an oak table; pair it with chairs that share its wood or sit quietly against it. Open shelving works only if you keep it to **tonal, repeated stoneware** — mismatched mugs undo a Japandi kitchen instantly. The terracotta lives in one or two pieces — a vessel, a paper lantern — never on the walls.

- ☐ Solid oak dining table — the anchor
- ☐ Chairs in matching or quiet wood — set of one design
- ☐ Tonal stoneware on open shelves — repeated, not collected
- ☐ One soft-black grounding element — lamp, frame, hardware
- ☐ Linen runner or placemats — texture on the table
- ☐ One terracotta vessel or lantern — the single warm note
- ☐ One pendant, warm bulb, over the table — 2700K

08 The entryway & the bathroom

PALETTES

01 *Oak & oak* · 03 *Stone & sage*

BUDGET RANGE

\$300–900 each

The entryway is the first calm signal — keep it to one oak bench or console, a single hook rail, one mirror, a basket for shoes, and one plant. Warm light, never an overhead glare. **The bathroom** takes stone & sage: stone-grey linen towels, one piece of soft sage, walnut or teak accents that handle damp, and one stoneware tray. Avoid charcoal — it reads dark in steam. Both rooms live or die on **concealment**: a Japandi entry and bath are calm because the clutter is in the basket and the cabinet, not on the surface.

- ☐ Oak bench or console, entry — one, low
- ☐ Hook rail + one mirror, entry — warm light, no glare
- ☐ Basket for shoes / bag — concealment is the point
- ☐ Stone-grey linen towels, bath — one tonal set
- ☐ One sage accent + teak/walnut tray, bath — damp-tolerant woods
- ☐ One stoneware vessel or stool — per room
- ☐ One plant or single stem — per room

PUTTING IT TOGETHER

The whole-home budget & *sequence*.

A starting-point order of operations. Do the rooms you live in most first — the calm compounds when you feel it daily. Ranges are USD; treat them as relative weights, not quotes.

Order	Room	Lead palette	Budget range
1	Living room	Oat & oak	\$1,400–3,200
2	Bedroom	Oat & oak / Stone & sage	\$1,100–2,600
3	Home office	Charcoal & cream	\$900–2,200
4	Kitchen & dining	Terracotta accent	\$700–2,000
5	Entryway	Oat & oak	\$300–900
6	Bathroom	Stone & sage	\$300–900
Whole home			\$4,700–11,800

If you do nothing else

Finish the living room and the bedroom to the checklist before touching the rest. Two rooms done well change how the whole home feels — and four half-rooms never will. Calm is a finished room, repeated.

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"A calm home isn't decorated all at once. It's built one finished room at a time — to the same five tones, the same two woods, the same quiet rule."

KEEP GOING

The free palette generator · calmandoak.com/palette

The Calm Home Calculator · calmandoak.com/calculator

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